

ies, a rise from 5.6% in first half of 2022. The group, which includes brands like VW, Audi, Skoda, Cupra, and Porsche, delivered around 322,000 EVs during this period. Volkswagen expects higher EV sales in the year's second half due to 'seasonal effects' and reduced delivery times. However, due to logistics bottlenecks, Volkswagen has reduced its overall delivery guidance by 500,000 for the year.

### onsemi secures \$1.95 billion in LTSAs with eight solar inverter suppliers

onsemi has secured \$1.95 billion in long-term supply agreements for its advanced power technologies in the booming solar inverter market by partnering with eight solar inverter suppliers. The company's advanced die technology, customised module design, and packaging offer competitive advantages to solar inverter manufacturers, enabling them to excel in time-to-market, product development, supply resilience, and quality assurance. Solar inverters, responsible for converting DC from solar panels to AC, face energy loss during the conversion. onsemi said its technology addresses this, making inverters compact, lightweight, and highly efficient, reducing energy wastage and overall system costs.

### Stellantis, Samsung SDI to establish second EV battery unit in US

French-Italian automaker Stellantis and South Korean battery manufacturer Samsung SDI are collaborating to establish a second joint-venture plant in the US for manufacturing EV batteries, with production slated to commence in 2027. This initiative aligns with Stellantis' goal to introduce 25 new battery electric vehicles in North America by the decade's end. The plant's initial production capacity will be 34 gigawatt hours (GWh). Stellantis and Samsung SDI are already collaborating on their first joint battery plant in Indiana, with plans for an initial capacity of 23GWh.

### EU approves \$47.5B CHIPS Act to promote chip manufacturing

The European Union has approved a \$47.5 billion incentive plan known as the CHIPS Act to enhance chip manufacturing, attract investments, and promote research and development in EU nations. This move aims to reduce dependency on foreign chip supplies and strengthen the EU's industrial

base for semiconductors. The incentive plan is anticipated to raise the semiconductor market share from 10% to 20% in the EU by 2030. Notably, Intel, a US-based semiconductor company, has initiated the construction of a new production unit in the EU region.

### 460 companies express interest in receiving US chip subsidy

The US Commerce Department reported that over 460 companies are interested in receiving government semiconductor subsidies to enhance the country's competitiveness with China's technology initiatives. President Biden's 'Chips for America' Act, signed a year ago, allocated \$52.7 billion for US semiconductor production, research, and workforce development. Detailed guidelines for accepting and evaluating subsidy applications have been developed over the past year, along with assembling a team of 140 individuals. Expected direct funding awards may range from 5% to 15% of project capital expenditures, and total award amounts are generally capped at 35%.

### Nvidia, Uber-backed startup Serve Robotics to go public

Serve Robotics, an autonomous sidewalk delivery robot startup and Uber spinout, is going public through a reverse merger with Patricia Acquisition Corp, a blank-check company. The company has raised a total of \$56 million and plans to use the financing to expand into new markets in the US and enhance its technology. The merger with Patricia was completed recently, following Serve Robotics raising \$30 million in a funding round led by existing investors, including Uber, Nvidia, and Wavemaker Partners. Uber will hold a 16.2% stake in the startup and Nvidia will hold an 11% stake after the merger.

### Tesla acquires wireless charging startup Wiferion

Tesla has officially acquired Germany-based wireless charging startup, Wiferion, to accelerate the development of its wireless charging platform potentially. This move aligns with Tesla's interest in self-driving technology and the potential for vehicles to charge themselves autonomously. Wiferion is known for its inductive charging technology for industrial robots and electric vehicles. The exact cost of the transaction hasn't been disclosed, but it's expected to be between \$50 million and \$100 million. Founded in 2016, Wiferion has deployed over 8,000 chargers, mainly for industrial robots.

ity and the smooth production flow at Foxconn.

### Union Cabinet approves allocation of ₹576.13 billion for e-Bus Sewa scheme

The Union Cabinet has approved the allocation of ₹576.13 billion for procuring 10,000 new electric buses across 169 cities under the PM e-Bus Seva scheme. The central government will contribute ₹200 billion and the state governments will cover the rest. The scheme

focuses on enhancing urban mobility, environmental sustainability, and climate change preparedness. The scheme's duration extends until 2037, with government support pledged for a decade.

### Servotech to set up ₹3 billion EV charger plant in UP

Servotech Power Systems has signed an MoU with the government of Uttar Pradesh to establish an EV charger manufacturing plant in the

state. The project, aligned with the Uttar Pradesh Electric Vehicle Manufacturing and Mobility Policy 2022, involves an investment of nearly ₹3 billion and aims to create over 500 jobs. The plant will manufacture 10,000 EV DC fast chargers annually, catering to domestic and export markets, and is scheduled to become partially operational by the first quarter of 2025. The company's subsidiary will manufacture EV charging components and batteries, aligning with its expansion plans.